

# Thomas Haferlach

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| CONTACT         | Email                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <a href="mailto:thomash@pollinations.ai">thomash@pollinations.ai</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
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|                 | Address                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Koepenicker Chaussee 26                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                 | City                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 10317 Berlin                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|                 | Country                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Germany                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| PROFILES        | <div><div> <a href="#">LinkedIn</a></div><div> <a href="#">GitHub</a></div><div> <a href="#">Artist Page</a></div></div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| SUMMARY         | AI researcher and entrepreneur with expertise in generative AI and LLMs, including developing and training models. Founder of Pollinations.AI, an open-source platform for generative AI. Experienced in developing and scaling AI platforms, APIs, and community building.                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| WORK EXPERIENCE | 1/2022                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>Founder &amp; Machine Learning Specialist at <a href="#">Pollinations.AI</a></b><br>  Berlin, Germany<br><br>Founded and developed an open-source generative AI platform. Built text and image APIs, model integrations and developer tooling, and supported the project's open-source community.          |
|                 | 9/2025 TILL 8/2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>Software Developer at Deel II GmbH</b><br>  Berlin, Germany                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|                 | 3/2023 TILL 8/2024                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>Senior Machine Learning Specialist at <a href="#">PIXELYNX</a></b><br>  Berlin, Germany · Remote<br><br>Led development of the generative AI platform Korus, focusing on audio and video. Implemented APIs and optimized machine learning models for real-time performance, including efficient inference. |
|                 | 6/2019 TILL 1/2022                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>Machine Learning Specialist at <a href="#">Pixtunes</a></b><br>  Berlin, Germany<br><br>Machine Learning Lead for the Pixtunes orchestra, an AI-based music production system. Secured €1.2 million in EU research funding.                                                                                |
|                 | 9/2018                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>Foresight Researcher &amp; AI Visualization Specialist at <a href="#">Envisioning</a></b><br>  Remote<br><br>Researched future trends of AI and technologies impacting sustainability. Led development of AI-driven future visualization projects.                                                         |
|                 | 1/2020 TILL 12/2022                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>AI Visualization Specialist at Cultural Institutions</b><br>  Berlin, Germany & Amsterdam, Netherlands<br><br>Developed AI-driven future visualization projects for the Humboldt Forum and Amsterdam Dance Event.                                                                                          |
|                 | 3/2018 TILL 6/2018                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>AI and Art Presenter &amp; Performer at MUTEK, Frontière IA &amp; transmediale</b><br>  Montreal, Canada & Berlin, Germany<br><br>Presented on AI in art and performed a musical piece using smartphones to create musical swarm intelligence.                                                             |

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| <div>3/2008 TILL 3/2016</div>                      | <div>Freelance Developer at Various Companies</div> <div>Brazil</div> <div>Developed interactive installations using machine learning, computer vision, and data visualization.</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <div>10/2006 TILL 2/2007</div>                     | <div>Software Engineer at <a href="#">Amazon Development Centre Scotland</a></div> <div>Edinburgh, United Kingdom</div> <div>Agile development of backend tooling, A/B testing and data mining for sales optimization.</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <div>EDUCATION</div> <div>1/2001 TILL 1/2006</div> | <div>The University of Edinburgh: Artificial Intelligence and Computer Science</div> <div>Bachelor of Science with <i>First class honors</i></div> <div>Thesis: <a href="#">Evolving Neural Models of Path Integration</a></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <div>PUBLICATIONS</div> <div>3/2007</div>          | <div><b>Evolving a Neural Model of Insect Path Integration</b> T. Haferlach, J. Wessnitzer, M. Mangan &amp; B. Webb</div> <div><a href="#">Adaptive Behaviour 15(3)</a></div> <div>Developed a neural model of insect path integration using a genetic algorithm, and implemented it on a robot.</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <div>AWARDS &amp; PROJECTS</div>                   | <div>AI-Generated Art and Music Installations</div> <div>Led several AI-driven art and music projects showcasing advanced AI techniques in creative contexts, including 'Marvin's Dream' (AI-generated narrative with spatial sound design), 'Cohabitation' (AI-enhanced urban planning visualization), and 'Traverse' (a project by Google featuring a VR experience with AI-generated soundscape).</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <div>LANGUAGES</div>                               | <div><b>English</b> (Native speaker)   <b>German</b> (Native speaker)   <b>Portuguese</b> (Full professional)   <b>French</b> (Basic conversational)</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <div>SKILLS</div>                                  | <div><b>Software Engineering:</b> Distributed Computing, Full Stack Development, API Development, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js, Git, Docker, Kubernetes</div> <div><b>Machine Learning:</b> Deep Learning, Generative AI, Large Language Models (LLMs), Diffusion Models, Computer Vision, Natural Language Processing, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Prompt Engineering, Fine-tuning, Model Serving, API Development, Data Processing Pipelines, Data Visualization</div> <div><b>Cloud Computing &amp; AI Platforms:</b> AWS, Google Cloud, Microsoft Azure, OpenAI API, Hugging Face, Replicate</div> <div><b>Soft Skills:</b> Open Source Project Management, Community Building, Technical Leadership, Cross-functional Collaboration, Problem Solving, Communication with Technical and Non-technical Audiences</div> |